

*These “big girls,” as we called them, were completely open about the number of offers they submitted.*

*My friend and I were so shocked by some of these people that we never held another convention, even though there was a big demand for us to do so. Years later, (in the late 1980s to the early 1990s) we attended conventions where people came from great distances. We met a woman who specialized in liquor deals. It turned out she had so many addresses in multiple states and she made so much money at it that she actually flew to her various mail drops to pick up her checks. Very shortly after what became our last convention, there was a lot of publicity about the “bust” at a refunding convention in upstate New York. “Coupon Connie’s” infamous arrest for printing fake coupons happened around that time, too. My friend and I decided it was not worth it to attend or hold conventions that essentially became a clearinghouse for some people to engage in inappropriate and illegal activities related to refunding. Over the years we became very disillusioned about what people would do to make a few bucks.*

More long-time couponers and refunders had only good memories, unaware of anything illegal or morally questionable going on at the conventions they attended. Betty Burrison was one of them. She remembered:

*In 1981, I moved to Maryland from New Jersey and became friends with a gal who refunded and used coupons, which I was also into. We were close to the Pennsylvania border and found out about a convention that was to be held there, so we decided to go. We arrived early with all our duplicate coupons, proofs of purchase, and extra*